

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Vicious cycle

POVERTY -> income and asset deprivation restricts the household food basket

-> FOOD INSECURITY: calorie deficit plus protein and micronutrient deficit

-> IMPAIRED DEVELOPMENT: cognitive, physical and immune capacity fall

-> LOW HUMAN CAPITAL: schooling attainment and productivity fall

-> LOW EARNINGS: the deprivation is transmitted to the next generation

MUST REMEMBER: Poverty, hunger, food insecurity, undernutrition and malnutrition overlap...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Security types

FOOD SECURITY -> reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food

CARRIED BY -> statutory foodgrain entitlement; a calorie and grain-access instrument

NUTRITION SECURITY -> dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices, sanitation

CONSEQUENCE -> the distribution system can work while nutrition outcomes stagnate

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Indicator card

STUNTING -> low height-for-age under five; chronic cumulative deprivation

WASTING -> low weight-for-height under five; recent or acute shortage or illness

ANAEMIA -> haemoglobin deficiency from iron, folate or vitamin B12 shortfall

SAM -> weight-for-height below minus three standard deviations; therapeutic care

MAM -> minus two to minus three standard deviations; community supplementary feeding

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Statutory entitlement card

ENACTED -> 5 July 2013; a shift from a welfare to a rights-based approach

QUANTUM -> 5 kg per person per month priority; 35 kg per household per month Antyodaya

COVERAGE RULE -> up to 75 per cent rural and 50 per cent urban population

OFFICIAL COUNT -> maximum coverage 81.34 crore persons; about 80 crore covered at present

HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD -> eldest woman aged 18 or above for issue of the ration card

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Price discipline card

STATUTORY CEILING -> rice 3 rupees, wheat 2 rupees, coarse grains 1 rupee per kilogram

CURRENT POLICY -> free of cost to Antyodaya and priority households since 1 January 2023

AUTHORITY -> the welfare grain scheme was merged into the Act on that date

EXTENSION -> the Union Cabinet extended free distribution for five years to December 2028

RULE -> never state the ceiling as the price a beneficiary currently pays

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Life-cycle provisions

PREGNANT AND LACTATING WOMEN -> nutritious meal free of cost; maternity benefit

MATERNITY BENEFIT -> not less than 6000 rupees to partly compensate wage loss

CHILDREN 6 MONTHS TO 14 YEARS -> meal through anganwadi centres and through schools

MALNOURISHED UNDER SIX -> higher nutritional norms are prescribed

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Poverty incidence is not depth, food availability is not household...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Remedy and responsibility

NON-SUPPLY -> the entitled person may claim a food security allowance from the State

GOVERNED BY -> the Food Security Allowance Rules, 2015

CENTRE -> allocation, transport to depots and assistance to the fair-price shop doorstep

STATES -> identification, ration cards and distribution of the entitlement

USE -> attribute a delivery failure to a named tier, never to government in general

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Service layers by age

POSHAN 2.0 -> Ministry of Women and Child Development; anganwadi centres

ITS SERVICES -> supplementary nutrition, growth monitoring, pre-school, referral

PM POSHAN -> Ministry of Education; cooked meal in Classes I to VIII

ITS OBJECTIVES -> attendance, retention and improved nutritional status

TRAP -> the ministry pairing is reversed in close-option questions

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Ration format trade-off

TAKE-HOME RATION -> dry ration cooked at home; pregnant and lactating women

ALSO FOR -> children between six months and three years

HOT COOKED MEAL -> served at the anganwadi centre or the school

GAIN -> the hot meal guarantees consumption at the point of delivery

COST -> it needs kitchen and staffing infrastructure; dry ration may be redistributed

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Portability mechanism

PROBLEM -> a migrant is listed on a State-specific roll and loses access on moving
-> MECHANISM: Aadhaar-seeded ration card read at an electronic point-of-sale machine
-> EFFECT: the existing entitlement is drawn at any enabled fair-price shop
LIMIT -> it is not a separate card and not a separate entitlement
CLAIM LIMIT -> the cumulative transaction count rises continuously and is not fixed here

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Convergence bank

NUTRITION-SPECIFIC -> feeding, micronutrients, growth monitoring, breastfeeding support

NUTRITION-SENSITIVE -> water and sanitation, agriculture, social protection, girls schooling

ANAEMIA -> the national anaemia strategy uses a six-by-six-by-six intervention design

FORTIFICATION -> reaches selected micronutrient gaps at scale

LIMIT -> it cannot replace dietary diversity, infection control, safe water or treatment

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Dated outcome and answer spine

ROUND FIVE 2019-21 -> stunting 35.5, wasting 19.3, child anaemia 67.1 per cent

ROUND SIX 2023-24 -> under-five stunting 29.3 per cent; released 29 May 2026

SCOPE -> round six covered 715 districts and about 6.79 lakh households

RULE -> name the round beside every value and never merge two rounds

CLOSE -> availability, access, absorption and utilisation, then a graded verdict

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use NFSA, PDS/ONORC, ICDS/Saksham Anganwadi,...